

BEYOND VIBE CODING

*Building the harness
for production agents*

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Six months ago I built an
automated DC events
newsletter.

It ships every day.

I improve the harness, not the
code.



We have a vocabulary problem.

harness

loop

software factory

Different labels for repeatable work.

graph

skill pack

autonomous factory

agent debt

The gap is the harness.



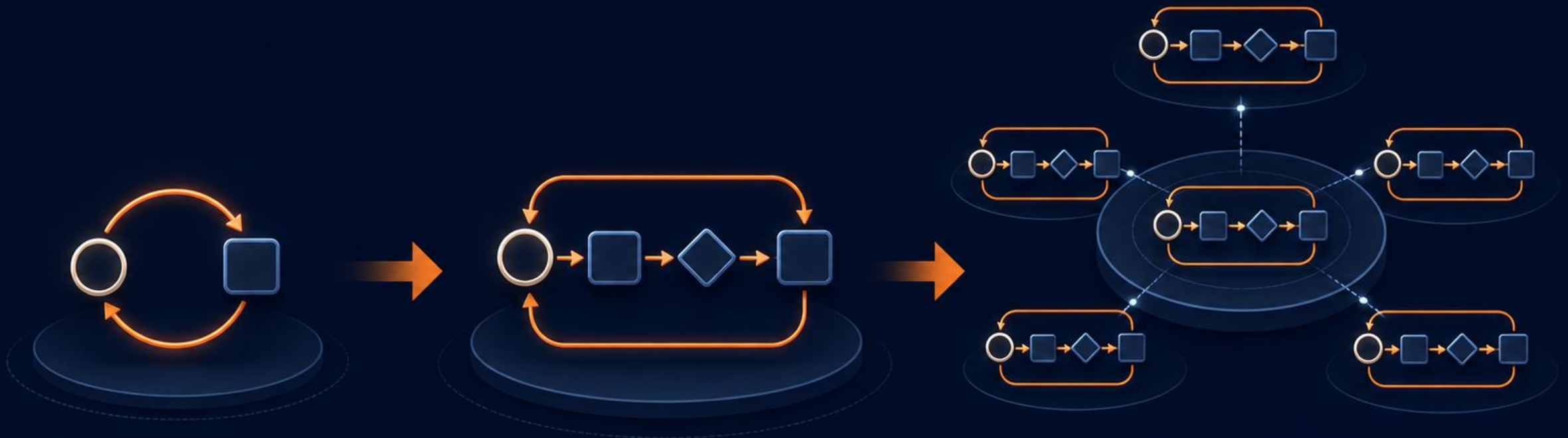
Build it once. Expand the scope.

Harnesses scale from tasks to systems.

ONE TASK

ONE WORKFLOW

MANY WORKFLOWS



As scope grows, the harness coordinates more.

- | | | |
|----|---------------------|----------------------|
| 01 | ONE TASK | clear instructions |
| 02 | ONE WORKFLOW | tools and checks |
| 03 | CONNECTED WORKFLOWS | reliable handoffs |
| 04 | CONTINUOUS SYSTEM | queues and approvals |

WHY SCOPE MATTERS

The bottleneck moves as scope grows.

ONE TASK

unclear goal

ONE WORKFLOW

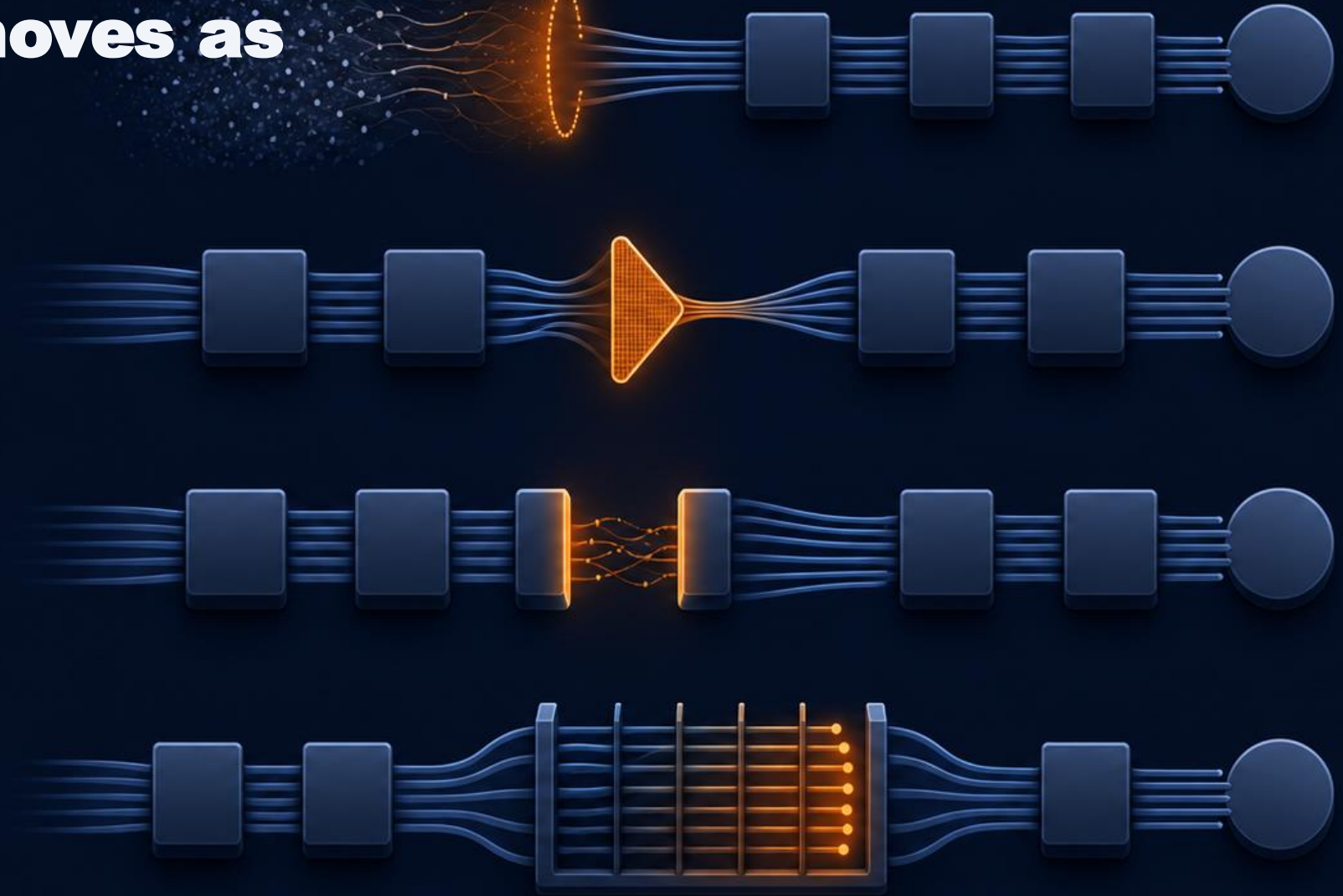
weak checks

CONNECTED WORKFLOWS

bad handoffs

CONTINUOUS SYSTEM

review queue



Protect your attention.

Build a harness around one workflow in six steps.

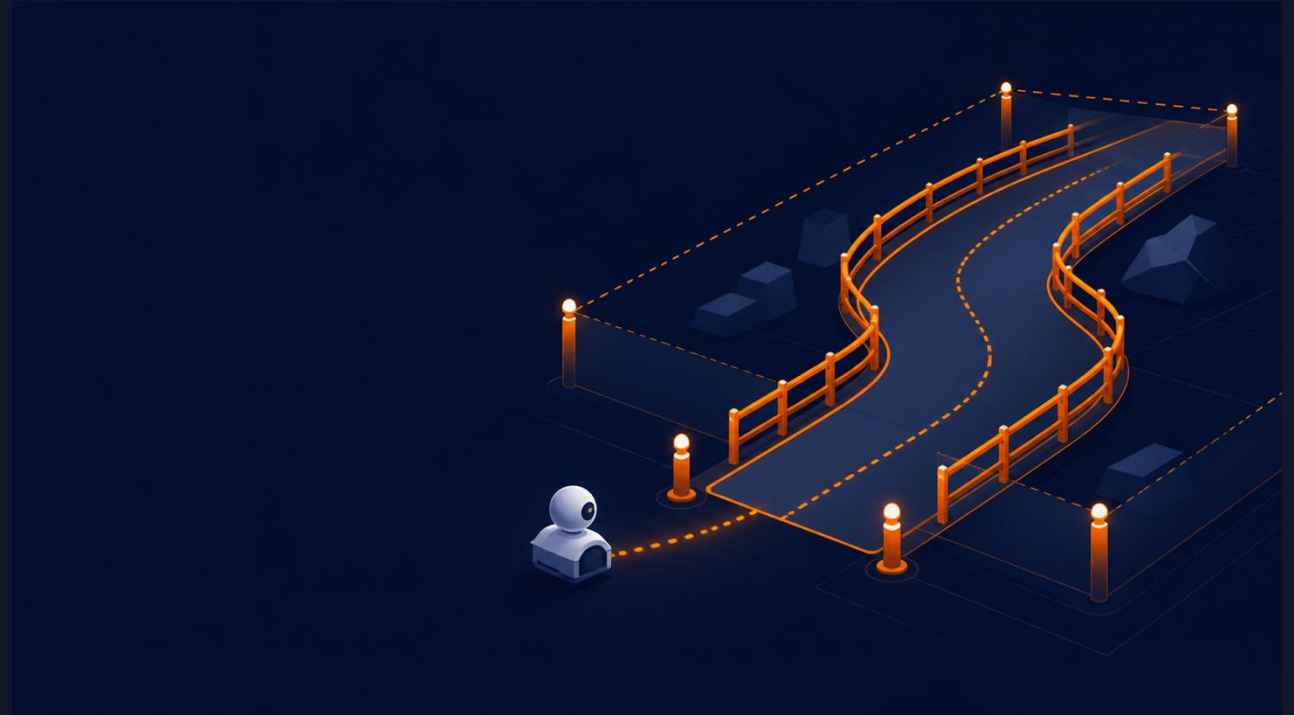
Pick one bottleneck task.

Start where your time
disappears.



Write the rules first.

Define what the agent may and may not do.



Move judgment into files.

Make preferences visible, versioned, and reusable.



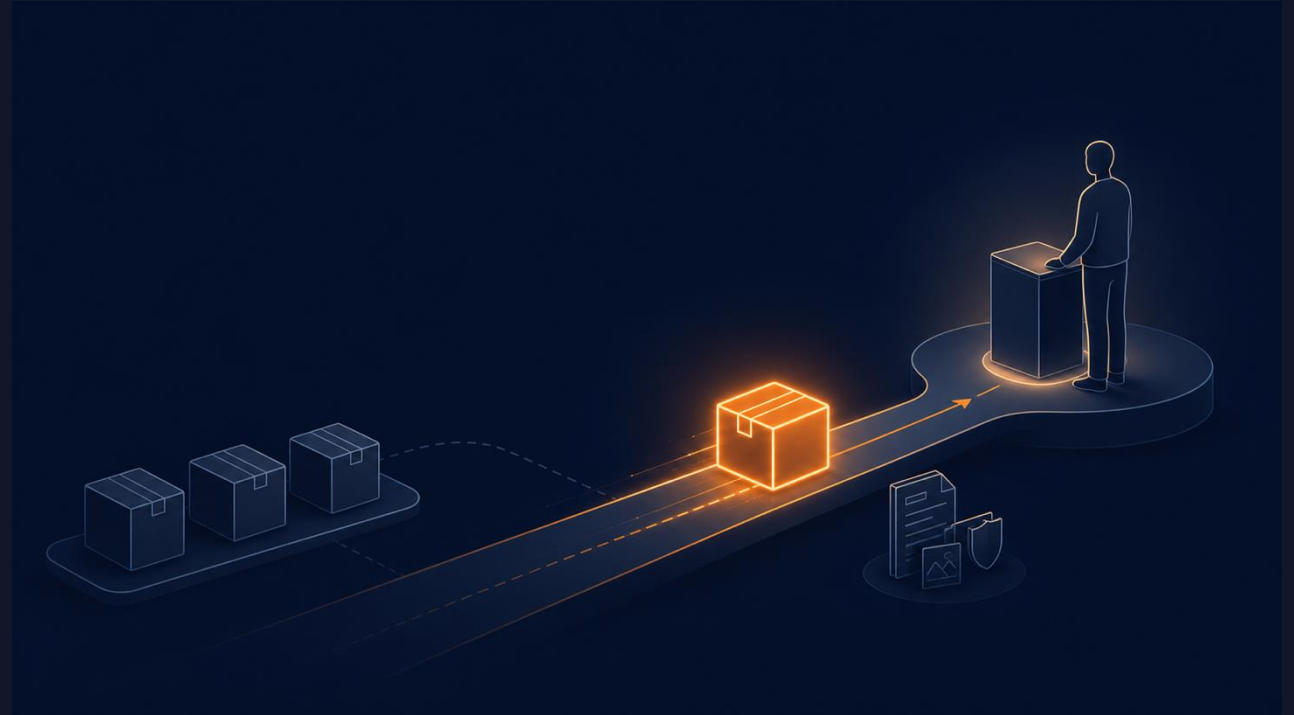
Build checks before generation.

Decide what good looks like
before you automate.



Make one change at a time.

Review one evidence-backed change.



Earn autonomy gradually.

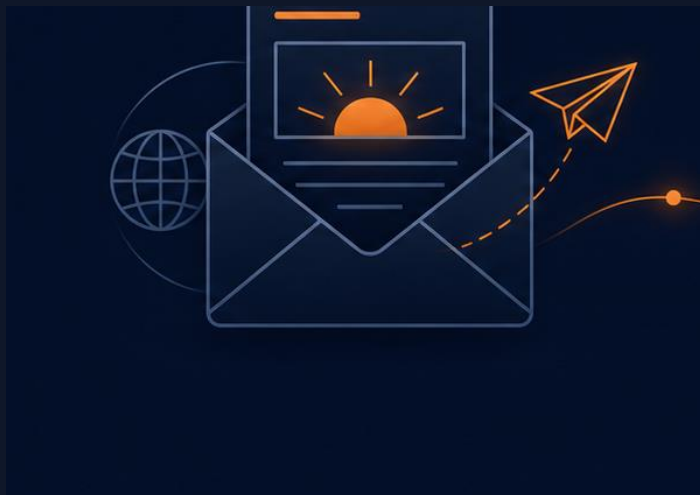
Reliable checks earn unattended runs.



The same six steps work for familiar jobs.

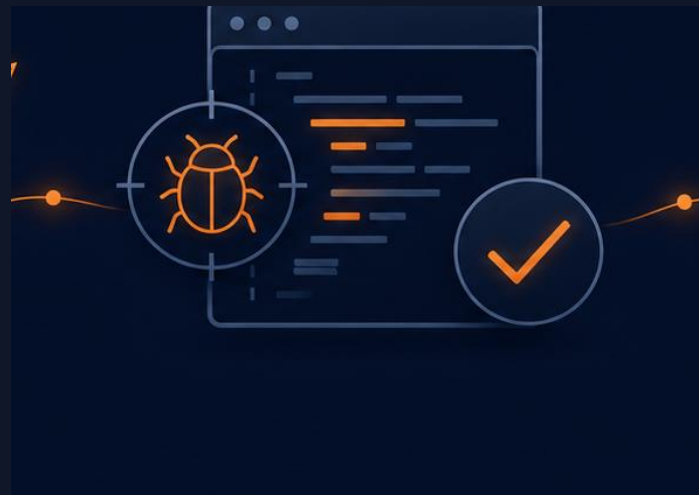
NEWSLETTER

events → daily edition



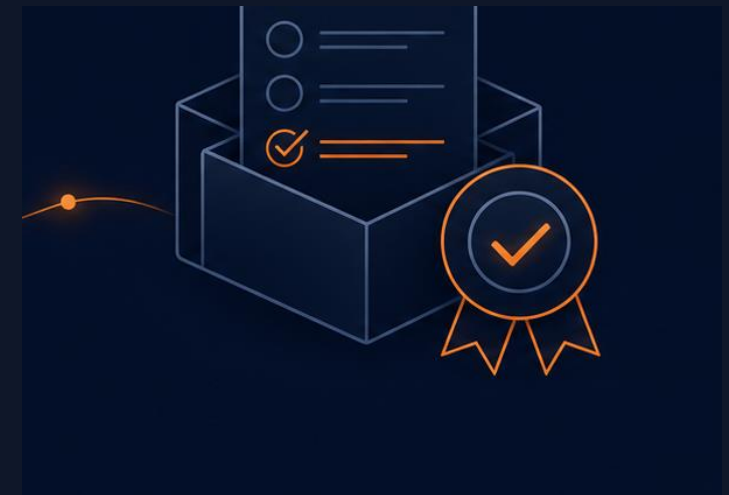
BUG FIX

report → tested patch



PRODUCT BACKLOG

issues → reviewed changes



Six steps built my newsletter.

- | | | |
|----|----------|-------------------------|
| 01 | TASK | Daily DC roundup |
| 02 | RULES | Local, timely, verified |
| 03 | JUDGMENT | Sources + scoring |
| 04 | CHECKS | Schema + links |
| 05 | REVIEW | Approve each edition |
| 06 | AUTONOMY | Schedule daily run |

Let me show you.

Live demo · weoutsidedc.com

Agents handle the repeatable work.

You own the judgment.

AGENTS

investigate, implement, test

YOU

choose, verify, approve

Build one repeatable outcome.

01 Pick the task

02 Write the rules

03 Put judgment in files

04 Build checks first

05 Merge with evidence

06 Earn unattended runs

A prompt gets you a result.

**A harness makes the workflow
repeatable.**

Build the harness. Improve the outcome.

GO DEEPER

Resources

Dex Horthy

Harness Engineering is not Enough

Anthropic

Getting started with loops

Automating a daily newsletter

end-to-end Codex build

Context engineering

Anthropic

Banjo

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Thank you.

Questions?

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